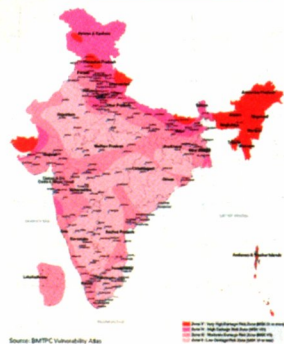


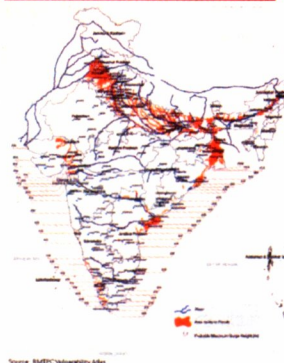
territories and states, including Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Orissa, Maharashtra, West Bengal, Kerala and nearby UTs. Even though only 84 coastal districts are threatened by cyclones, there are expected to be almost 30 crore beneficiaries in the coastal areas, which is nearly one-third of the total population of India.

EARTHQUAKE ZONES IN INDIA



domain so that people can have free access to their provisions. Retrofitting of all the district hospitals (229) in seismic Zones IV and V will be undertaken as a part of this scheme.

FLOOD ZONES IN INDIA



Information Services (INCOIS), Hyderabad, as a part of better preparedness measures for Tsunami.

4. Better communications — There's an urgent need to set up a dedicated and failsafe communication network for disaster management. It will also include the provisioning of equipment for immediate restoration of communication at

2. National Earthquake Risk Mitigation Project (NERMP) — This project aims towards training 90,000 engineers, 24,000 architects, 2,25,000 building contractors, and equal number of construction supervisors and 4,50,000 masons in the first five years. This will include around five to ten per cent of the total work force in various categories involved in the construction industry in India. It is also being planned to place the National Building Code 2005 and other safety related codes in the public

3. Early warnings — A major refurbishing of forecasting and early warning systems of Indian Meteorological Department (IMD) is being initiated by the Ministry of Earth Sciences. Upgradation of the capabilities of early warning systems with the Central Water Commission (CWC) will be undertaken as part of the National Flood Mitigation Project, which is already in the planning stage. An early warning centre for Tsunami has already been established at the Indian National Centre for Ocean

the disaster sites for all the 241 most disaster prone districts in the country, thus, ensuring better last mile connectivity.

5. National-level Reserves — This project deals with making adequate provisions for meeting immediate requirements for severe disasters which are beyond the coping capacity of the states. These reserves will meet the needs of approximately 3,25,000 personnel affected by disasters and will be kept at nine NDRF locations.

Better preparedness

The states are proposed to train and equip one battalion equivalent force from within their existing organisations of armed police and fire brigades. Steps will be taken for revamping civil defence and upgrading the fire services.

The operationalisation of the eight NDRF battalions is under rapid progress. 2100 NDRF personnel have been trained in chemical, biological, radiological and nuclear emergencies (CBRN); 1260 in heli-borne slithering and over 7000 personnel have been trained in Collapsed Structure Search and Rescue (CSSR), besides Medical First Responder (MFR) and Watermanship training. Companies from these eight battalions are planned to be located at 33 locations in various parts of the country. This is aimed to cut down on the response delays, which is especially critical in the case of man-made emergencies. Equipping of this force is expected to be completed within the next 9-12 months.

Since disasters do not recognise geographical boundaries, it will be the national endeavour to provide for cooperation and coordination at the international level in all the spheres of disaster management. The establishment of SAARC DM Centre at the NIDM in New Delhi is a major step in this direction.

Road Ahead

Concerted efforts are being made to formulate appropriate policies and guidelines for drawing out plans which will ensure effective and synergised disaster management at all levels.

There's need to make necessary financial allocation for prevention, preparedness and mitigation rather than fruitlessly incur post-disaster expenditure year after year. The biggest challenge will be to implement, monitor and coordinate multi-sectoral efforts. However, with the kind of enthusiasm and awareness now being displayed by most of the states and various stakeholders, it should be possible to work out a system where functional efficiency, independent monitoring and accountability will become the key areas in our national approach to bring about this envisaged paradigm shift in disaster management.



MOCK EXERCISE NALBARI (ASSAM) – 18th MAY 2007